

COURSE 3 - DATA ENGINEERING 2026

C3-07 - Start Here

Cloud/Fabric implementation route, trial timing, platform-evidence boundary and low-resource workflow.

Artifact	C3-07-START
Status	2026 - LEARNER EDITION
Phase	C3-07 Cloud & Microsoft Fabric Data Engineering 15 lessons 50-70 focused hours
Prerequisite	C3-06 Gate PASS; C2B cloud foundations are recalled, while Fabric implementation is taught from first principles.
Current lane	Microsoft Fabric docs refreshed 2026-09-11 trial 60 days F4/F64 up to 1 TB OneLake
Brand	Charcoal #1F2937 Teal #14B8A6 Soft Blue #3B82F6 AMOLED #000

House teaching rule: mental picture -> tiny example -> guided Fabric action -> expected result -> why it worked -> break/fix -> independent changed case -> validation -> security/production reasoning -> evidence. A portal screenshot is not mastery unless the underlying data, identity, lifecycle and recovery claim is independently verified.

Study route

- Complete C3-080 L01, then P01; save attempt before R01; complete changed retry if needed. Continue through L15.
- After all 15 lessons are mastered, attempt StoreLake Mini-Lab independently.
- Only after Mini-Lab completion attempt PlantFabric Gate A. B/C remain sealed unless explicitly assigned after targeted repair.
- Use one browser + light editor/Git during Fabric work. Keep local Kafka/Airflow/Spark services closed unless the exact task requires them.

Trial timing

Fabric trial currently lasts 60 days and provides either F4 or F64 trial capacity, up to 1 TB in OneLake, and access to Fabric workloads such as Data Factory, Data Engineering and Real-Time Analytics. Activate near C3-07 study time rather than months early. Some features are unavailable in trial, including Copilot, Trusted Workspace Access and Private Link.

Live evidence boundary

A diagram, local script or current doc can prove reasoning. It cannot prove a Fabric pipeline/notebook/Spark Job/Warehouse/Eventhouse/Git deployment/security role/Monitoring Hub/capacity behavior actually ran. Mark those items PENDING until observed in an eligible tenant.

Current Data Factory decision

For simple movement, evaluate Copy Job first because current Microsoft guidance calls it the preferred simplified data-movement solution with bulk, incremental and CDC delivery styles. Use Copy activity when movement belongs inside a larger orchestrated pipeline. Dataflow Gen2 remains useful for Power Query-style transformations.